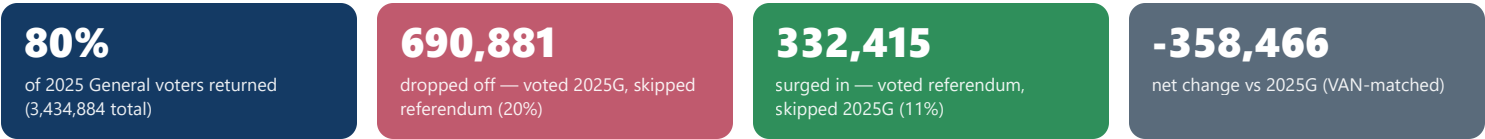


Referendum 2026 — Voter Churn: Drop-off & Surge

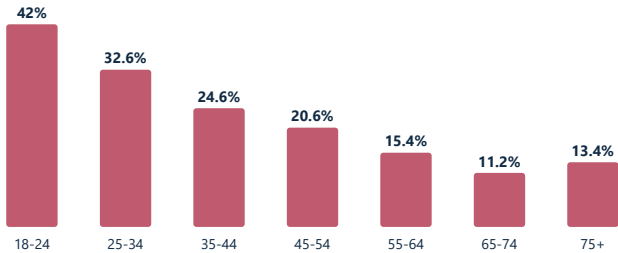
Who left and who arrived between the 2025 General and the April 21, 2026 referendum · DPVA · 2026-05-21



Who dropped off — 2025 General voters who didn't return

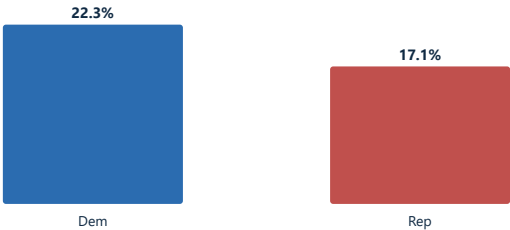
Drop-off rate by age

% of each band's 2025G voters who skipped the referendum



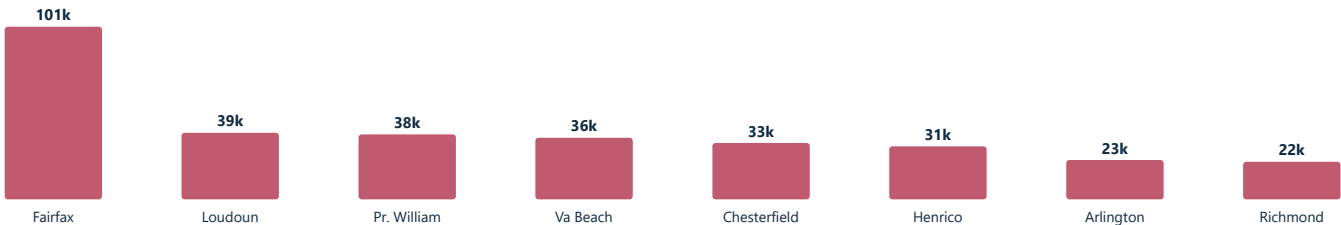
Drop-off rate by party

Van party ID + Dem-support score



Where the lost voters are — top localities by drop-off count

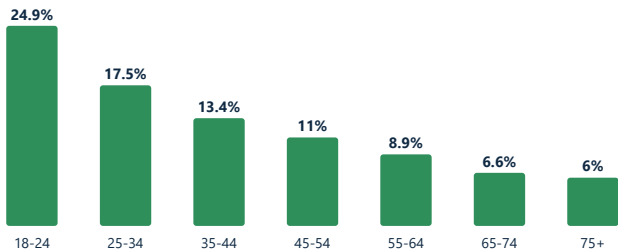
thousands of 2025G voters who didn't return



Who surged in — referendum voters who skipped 2025G

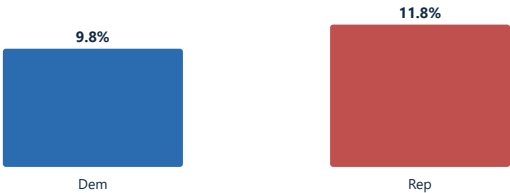
Surge rate by age

% of each band's referendum voters who skipped 2025G



Surge rate by party

Van party ID + Dem-support score



What it means

- Drop-off skews young and Democratic.** 22% of Dem 2025G voters dropped vs 17% of Republicans, and 42% of 18–24s. The Yes win came *despite* losing more of the Dem base — cushioned by its size.
- Surge skews young but slightly Republican.** New-to-2025G referendum voters were 11.8% of Rep voters vs 9.8% of Dems — Democrats lost more of their base *and* replaced less of it.
- Re-mobilization target:** young, Dem-leaning 2025 voters — highest volume in Fairfax / Loudoun / Prince William, highest rate in college towns (Harrisonburg, Charlottesville, Williamsburg). Voter-level list available (held privately, VAN-ready).

Eligibility note: the youngest surge band is modestly inflated by ~5,400 voters who turned 18 after the 2025 General (eligible for the referendum, not 2025G) — only 1.6% of all surge. Excluding them, the 18–24 surge rate is **22.8%** rather than 24.9%, so the young tilt is overwhelmingly genuine. Source: 2025-General vote history and 2026 referendum participation matched in the VAN voter file (Van party ID + Dem-support score). "Drop-off" and "surge" are limited to voters present in VAN; ~25k referendum voters with no VAN record (new registrations) are additional surge. Aggregate counts only — no individual voter data. Detail: analysis/LTV2026_Ref_Analysis.md §5i–5j.